

them are Java sourced, like Flipkart, Snapdeal or Myntra and if you look at their tech stacks, it is a lot of open source. You might think I am one of the few telling that talent is easy to find, but we do have quite a few companies who are actually able to find and use this talent.

Q When did your tryst with open source technology begin?

We started to do small projects during my third year of college in IIT. We did a lot of niche PoCs and then I did my internship at the University of Paris. There were a couple of professors there who were extremely pro-Java and pro-open source. So, working with them for three months actually exposed me to a lot that I was unaware of earlier. That experience got me more interested. Over the first four years of my job, I worked on five or six different languages including C++, Java, Perl and Ruby.

Q What's your primary language right now?

None. I am supposed to be a pro, across the board. To me, there are a lot of solutions that themselves shout out for certain languages to be implemented. So, if you want to build an extremely scalable enterprise solution that supports 10,000 concurrent users, or a million users or hits at a time, per day, you would probably go with Java. However, if you want to go to market pretty quickly with a website, and your investment pressures or your go-to-market strategy forces you to get that done within 1.5 months, you will probably not go with Java and select Ruby instead. So, it really depends on what your product vision is and what's the technology that your product is looking for. The decision is taken on that basis. Basically, the technology choice, more often than not, lies in the problem statement itself.

Q How easy or difficult is it for you to convince the management about using open source?

We are 50 per cent open source and 50 per cent proprietary. So, that has never been an issue. The management has always been convinced about it. Good techies guys have founded this company and have been around for quite some time, so open source has always been in the company's blood. Even today, our management is pretty supportive of what the technology team says. When members of my engineering team back up the solution and say that they can do it, we rarely face any resistance from the management.

Q Are there any community contributions that your people do?

Yes. A lot of our people are pretty active on blogs and forums. At times, the CTO office is involved in global capacity contribution but at an individual level too, we contribute pretty often. In GlobalLogic, senior people have a part of their salary as a bonus component. More often than not, 15-20 per cent of that component is earned by their contribution to the blogging world, the open source world and the world

of technology. So, we have a concept wherein a part of the bonus is reserved for performances or contributions that they have made to the project, to the company or to the technology world, in general.

Q Twelve years back when you started, was open source technology as good as it is today? What were the challenges then?

I think it was even better than today. Now, there are a lot of proprietary solutions available and the world has evolved a lot. Even Java solutions today are proprietary. At that time, Sun was completely backed by open source and, today, I would say that the market is 25-30 per cent open source. At that time, it was at least 50 per cent open source. There was a lull that we saw in the middle. But in the past two years, with the mobile revolution coming in, the open source wave has started to pick up momentum again.

Q How much do you see it changing in another 3-5 years?

I think it's in a stable state. It is here to stay because the IT world today is completely oriented around innovation. There's a lot of competition around products. Let's take the example of e-commerce products. There are at least 10 portals in India, of which three or four are in the top league and they are pretty close in terms of their competitiveness. Their only differentiation is in the kind of features and the ease of use they provide.

Any company amongst these that comes up with two or three attractive features first, gets the advantage of taking a leap forward. And in such sectors, whenever you mention innovation, open source is kind of a front-runner, by default. There are a lot of people and good thinkers around who think up something, write code for it and put it in. So, whenever you talk about innovation, a lot that's new and path-breaking would be open source. So, I think in the next two-three years, we will see a lot of evolution in open source.

Q What are the areas in which you see open source growing a lot?

If you talk about domains, retail e-commerce, mobility and media will continue to have a lot of open source elements. IoT is an extremely vast playground, where open source will play a very large role because that's a field which is still evolving. There will be a lot of media solutions. Media is changing a lot. There are very few people who read news on a desktop today. It's all mobile. People read the news, like, share, cut elements, etc, all on-the-go; so this is another area that will have a lot of open source contribution.

Q Is open source still a back-end property?

I really don't see any reason why that would be the case. In fact, many of the front-end operations use mostly open source, because it's much more feasible to do so. 